# Note Values and Rests

A **beat** is the steady pulse that music is counted in. A **note value** is the length of a note in beats, shown by its shape: a hollow or filled notehead, with or without a stem and flag. In this chapter the quarter note receives one beat. A **rest** is a symbol for silence. Each note value has a matching rest of the same length.

| Note | Symbol | Beats | Rest symbol | Rest |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Whole note |  | 4 |  | Whole rest |
| Half note |  | 2 |  | Half rest |
| Quarter note |  | 1 |  | Quarter rest |
| Eighth note |  | ½ |  | Eighth rest |

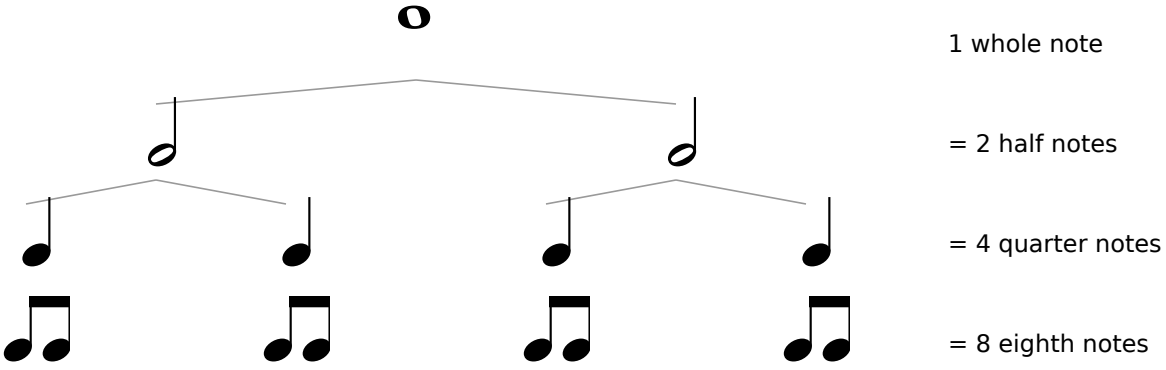
The **stem** is the vertical line attached to the notehead. The **flag** is the curved line on the stem of an eighth note. A **beam** is a thick line that joins the stems of two or more eighth notes in place of their flags. Two eighth notes, flagged or beamed, equal one quarter note.



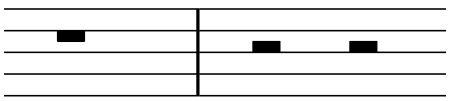
Two flagged eighth notes = Two beamed eighth notes

## Dividing the whole note

Each note value is half the length of the one above it.




The whole rest and the half rest have the same shape. Their position on the staff tells them apart: the whole rest hangs below the fourth line, and the half rest sits on top of the third line.



whole rest half rest

© 2026 Matthew Menard. All rights reserved.

Name _____ Date _____

# Note Values and Rests

**A. Equal values** Write the number that answers each item.

**EXAMPLE** Quarter notes in one half note: 2

2. Quarter notes in one whole note: _____
4. Eighth notes in one half note: _____
6. Beats in a whole rest: _____
8. Quarter rests in one half rest: _____
1. Half notes in one whole note: _____
3. Eighth notes in one quarter note: _____
5. Eighth notes in one whole note: _____
7. Beats in a half rest: _____
9. Eighth rests in one quarter rest: _____

**B. Match names and symbols** Write the letter of the matching name under each symbol.

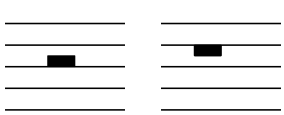
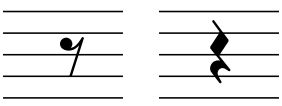
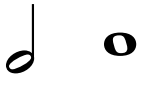
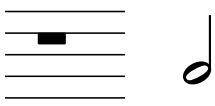
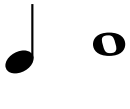
**A** whole note **B** half note **C** quarter note **D** eighth note **E** whole rest **F** half rest **G** quarter rest **H** eighth rest

**EXAMPLE**  C

1.  _____
2.  _____
3.  _____
4.  _____
5.  _____
6.  _____
7.  _____

**C. Which is longer?** Circle the symbol that lasts longer.

**EXAMPLE** 

1. 
2. 
3. 
4. 
5. 
6. 
7. 
8. 

© 2026 Matthew Menard. All rights reserved.